Fennel and the Big Red Mad

A story about big feelings

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Red Mad

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For every little bear
with a big feeling.

Fennel Bear woke up with the sun,

ready for a day of fun.

He built a tower, tall and grand,

the tallest tower in all the land.

Then CRASH! It tumbled, block by block.

Fennel froze in total shock.

Grrrr went his tummy.
His paws squeezed tight.

His cheeks puffed up with all his might.

“I’M MAD!” roared Fennel. “SO MAD!” he said.

The mad grew big like a red balloon,
and it might go BOOM quite soon!

Mama Bear knelt down, soft and slow.

“Big mads are hard. I know, I know.”

“Breathe in slow, smell a flower sweet.

Breathe out slow, blow the candle neat.”

“Stomp your feet, one-two, one-two!

Shake the mad out, through and through!”

“Now tell me, Fennel, what is wrong?”

“My tower fell… it took so long.”

The balloon got smaller, smaller still,

until it fit on his windowsill.

“Let’s build it back together, then.”

And Fennel smiled. And smiled again.

Now when big mads come knocking, you see,

Fennel knows just what to do: Breathe.
Stomp. Tell. And he's calm as can be.

Fennel's 3 Calm-Down Steps

1. BREATHE

Smell the flower. Blow the candle.

2. STOMP

Stomp your feet. Shake it out!

3. TELL

Tell someone what is wrong.

Big feelings are okay.

What you do next is the brave part.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel mad.”

Stay calm and breathe together.

Practice the three steps when everyone is calm.

Praise the effort, not just the result.

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.